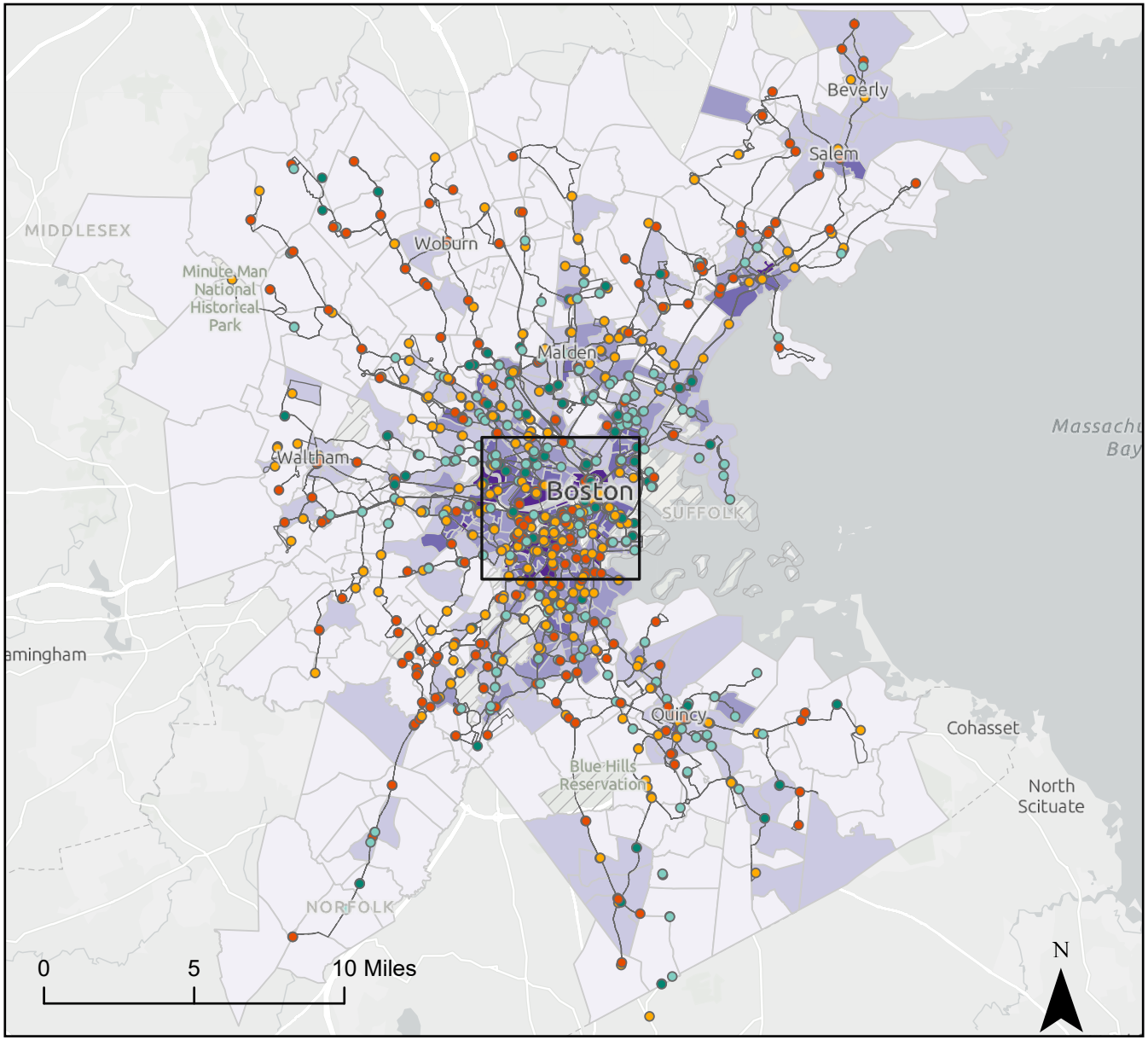
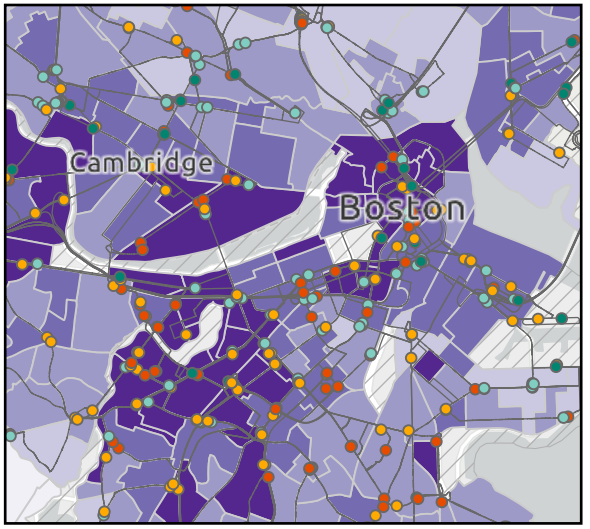
Buses run least reliably in outer, car-owning areas, not in car-free neighborhoods

Share of 2025 bus timepoints on time, over the share of households without a car



Downtown Boston and Cambridge



Share of timepoints on time

- Under 60%
- 60% - 70%
- 70% - 80%
- Over 80%

Percent of households without a car

- Under 10%
- 10% - 20%
- 20% - 35%
- 35% - 50%
- Over 50%
- Fewer than 100 households

Data: MBTA Bus Arrival Departure Times 2025; MBTA GTFS, October 2025; U.S. Census Bureau ACS 2020–2024 5-year estimates. On time per MBTA Service Delivery Policy standards (target: 70%). Tracts with fewer than 100 households hatched. Map: Alex Weinstein, 2026. Basemap Sources: Esri, TomTom, Garmin, (c) OpenStreetMap contributors, and the GIS User Community, Sources: Esri, TomTom, Garmin, FAO, NOAA, USGS, (c) OpenStreetMap contributors, and the GIS User Community